

FREE 8-WEEK TRAINING PROGRAM

HYROX BASE BUILDER

The program that bridges "I understand HYROX" and "I'm ready to race it." Eight weeks of structured station work, running, and compromised-running sessions built for people who've done the homework and want a plan, not more theory.

ALEX WATSON — BSc HONS · L3 PT · L1 S&C

WHY MOST HYROX PLANS FAIL

Most free HYROX plans are a running plan with some workouts bolted on, or a CrossFit-style WOD list with no running structure. Neither reflects what actually happens on race day: eight stations, each one preceded by a kilometre of running on legs that are already compromised from the station before.

This program is built around one principle: **train the transition, not just the pieces**. Every week includes sessions where you run into fatigue and then perform a station, or perform a station and then run — because that's the actual demand of the race. Isolated station strength and isolated running fitness are necessary, but they are not sufficient.

Who this is for: you've got a running base (comfortable covering 5-8km) and you've either read the HYROX beginner guide or you already know your way around the eight stations. This isn't a couch-to-HYROX plan — it's the bridge from "capable" to "race ready."

Structure: 3 sessions per week, roughly 60-75 minutes each. Three phases:

PHASE	WEEKS	FOCUS
Base	1-3	Work capacity across all 8 stations, running base, technique under mild fatigue
Build	4-6	Increased loads and intensity, stations combined back-to-back, compromised running
Peak	7-8	Partial then full race simulation, taper into your test

Loading: where a load is given, it's expressed as a percentage of bodyweight (%BW) or by RPE (rate of perceived exertion, 1-10) rather than a fixed kg figure — this program is written for a general audience with a wide range of starting strength. Use a load you could do for 3-4 more reps than prescribed if pushed.

Equipment: a gym with a ski erg, rower, sled (or heavy resistance alternative), sandbag or heavy bag, kettlebells or dumbbells for farmers carries, and a wall ball. No access to a sled or ski erg? Substitutes are noted at the bottom of each week.

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH & STATION TECHNIQUE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, moderate load	6 x 20m	Focus on drive angle, not speed
Walking lunges (bodyweight or light DB)	3 x 20 (10/leg)	Mirrors sandbag lunge pattern
Wall balls	4 x 15	Full depth squat, soft catch
Farmers carry, heavy	4 x 40m	Grip is the limiter — own it
Plank / dead bug	3 x 30-40s	Core stability for carries

SESSION 2 – RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy jog + drills
Main set	6 x 400m @ 5k pace, 90s jog recovery
Cool-down	10 min easy jog

SESSION 3 – FULL-BODY CIRCUIT + COMPROMISED RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	Comfortable, controlled pace
SkiErg	500m, steady effort
1km run	Same pace as above — notice the difference
Row	500m, steady effort
1km run	Hold pace, this is the point of the session
Burpee broad jumps	40m, controlled

NO SLED/SKI ERG? Sub sled push for heavy prowler push or loaded farmer carry uphill. Sub ski erg for rowing or an assault bike at matched effort.

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH & STATION TECHNIQUE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, moderate-heavy load	6 x 25m	+25% distance from Week 1
Walking lunges	3 x 24 (12/leg)	Add light load if bodyweight felt easy
Wall balls	4 x 18	
Farmers carry, heavy	4 x 50m	
Weighted plank / dead bug	3 x 40s	

SESSION 2 – RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy jog + drills
Main set	5 x 600m @ 5k pace, 2 min jog recovery
Cool-down	10 min easy jog

SESSION 3 – FULL-BODY CIRCUIT + COMPROMISED RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	Controlled pace
Sled pull	25m, moderate load
1km run	Hold pace
Sandbag lunges	50m
1km run	Hold pace
Wall balls	40 reps

Progression check: pace should hold within 5-10s/km across all three run reps. If it's falling off badly, that's your signal – not a failure, just data for Week 3.

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH & STATION TECHNIQUE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, heavy load	6 x 25m	Increase load, hold distance
Walking lunges, loaded	3 x 24	
Wall balls	4 x 20	
Farmers carry, heavy	5 x 50m	

SESSION 2 – RUNNING BENCHMARK

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy jog
Test	3km time trial, all-out sustainable effort
Cool-down	10 min easy jog

Record this time. You'll repeat it in Week 8 as one marker of progress.

SESSION 3 – MINI SIMULATION

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	
SkiErg 500m	
1km run	
Sled push 25m	
1km run	
Burpee broad jumps 40m	
1km run	
Row 500m	

Note total time. First real look at how the pieces link together.

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH & STATION TECHNIQUE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, heavy	5 x 30m	
Sled pull, moderate	5 x 25m	Now added as its own station block
Sandbag lunges	3 x 20	
Wall balls	4 x 20	
Farmers carry, heavy	5 x 60m	

SESSION 2 – RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy
Main set	4 x 1km @ target race pace, 2 min jog recovery
Cool-down	10 min easy

SESSION 3 – COMPROMISED RUNNING (2 STATIONS BACK-TO-BACK)

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	
SkiErg 500m into Sled push 20m	No rest between the two stations
1km run	
Row 500m into Wall balls x 20	No rest between the two stations
1km run	

This is where the program starts to feel like HYROX rather than a gym session. Expect pace to drop on these runs – that's expected and it's exactly what you're training to manage.

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH & STATION TECHNIQUE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, heavy	5 x 30m	Increase load from Week 4
Sled pull, heavy	5 x 25m	
Sandbag lunges	3 x 24	
Wall balls	5 x 20	
Farmers carry, heavy	5 x 60m	

SESSION 2 – RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy
Main set	6 x 800m @ race pace or faster, 90s recovery
Cool-down	10 min easy

SESSION 3 – COMPROMISED RUNNING (3 STATIONS BACK-TO-BACK)

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	
Burpee broad jumps 40m into Sled push 20m into Wall balls x15	No rest between stations
1km run	
SkiErg 400m into Farmers carry 40m into Row 400m	No rest between stations

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH & STATION TECHNIQUE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, heavy	4 x 30m	Slightly reduced volume, hold intensity
Sandbag lunges	3 x 24	
Wall balls	4 x 20	
Farmers carry, heavy	4 x 60m	

SESSION 2 – RUNNING BENCHMARK

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy
Test	Repeat the Week 3 3km time trial
Cool-down	10 min easy

SESSION 3 – HALF SIMULATION

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	
SkiErg 1000m	
1km run	
Sled push 50m	
1km run	
Sled pull 50m	
1km run	
Burpee broad jumps 80m	

Full first-half of race stations at full HYROX distances. Record total time and compare pacing to Week 3's mini simulation.

SESSION 1 – STRENGTH MAINTENANCE

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, moderate	4 x 25m	Reduce load slightly, stay sharp
Wall balls	3 x 20	
Farmers carry	4 x 50m	

SESSION 2 – RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
Warm-up	10 min easy
Main set	4 x 1km @ race pace, full recovery
Cool-down	10 min easy

SESSION 3 – FULL RACE SIMULATION

BLOCK	DETAIL
1km run	SkiErg 1000m
1km run	Sled push 50m
1km run	Sled pull 50m
1km run	Burpee broad jumps 80m
1km run	Row 1000m
1km run	Farmers carry 200m
1km run	Sandbag lunges 100m
1km run	Wall balls 100 reps

Full HYROX distances, all 8 stations. Record total time — this is your dress rehearsal.

SESSION 1 – SHORT & SHARP

EXERCISE	SETS X REPS	NOTES
Sled push, light-moderate	3 x 20m	Movement quality, not fatigue
Wall balls	2 x 15	

SESSION 2 – EASY RUNNING

BLOCK	DETAIL
Run	20-30 min easy, 4 x 20s strides

SESSION 3 – THE TEST

BLOCK	DETAIL
Full simulation or race day	Repeat the Week 7 full simulation at full effort, or race it for real if you've got an event booked

Compare this time against Week 7. Whatever the number, you've gone from "understands HYROX" to "has trained through it" in eight weeks — and you now know exactly where your next block of work needs to go.

WEEK	3KM TT / SIMULATION	TIME	NOTES
3	3km TT		
3	Mini simulation (4 stations)		
6	3km TT		
6	Half simulation (4 stations, full distance)		
7	Full simulation		
8	Full simulation / race		

WHAT NOW

YOU'VE DONE THE STRUCTURED VERSION. NOW MAKE IT YOURS.

This program gets you race-ready in general terms. Coaching gets you a plan built around your actual pace, your actual schedule, and your actual weaknesses — adjusted week to week instead of fixed on a page.

[BOOK A FREE CONSULT →](#)

alexwatsoncoach@email · [@alexwatsoncoach](#) · [\[website\]](#)